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NATIONAL IRON PLUS INITIATIVE (NIPI / ANEMIA MUKT BHARAT)

Operational Guidelines for Prophylaxis & Management of Iron Deficiency Anemia

Child & Maternal Health Division · Ministry of Health and Family Welfare

1. Life Cycle Approach to Anemia Prevention

• Universal Iron & Folic Acid (IFA) supplementation targeting 6 population groups from infancy through motherhood.

• Pregnant women: 1 Red IFA tablet (60 mg elemental iron + 500 mcg folic acid) daily for at least 180 days starting from 2nd trimester (14 weeks onwards) and 180 days postpartum.

• Lactating mothers: Continue 1 Red IFA tablet daily throughout lactation period.

2. Therapeutic Triage for Anemic Beneficiaries

• Mild Anemia (Hb 10.0 - 10.9 g/dL): Standard prophylactic dose of 1 tablet daily with dietary counseling.

• Moderate Anemia (Hb 7.0 - 9.9 g/dL): Therapeutic dose of 2 Red IFA tablets daily (morning and evening after meals) for 100 days until Hb normalizes.

• Severe Anemia (Hb < 7.0 g/dL): Immediate referral to PHC/FRU for parenteral iron (Iron Sucrose / Ferric Carboxymaltose) or blood transfusion.

3. Biannual Deworming Convergence

• Pregnant women receive Albendazole 400 mg single dose chewable tablet in the 2nd trimester (after 14 weeks) during National Deworming Day.

• Counsel against taking IFA simultaneously with milk, tea, or calcium to avoid iron absorption inhibition.

Official Government Publication for Field Operational Reference. Sourced from National Health Mission / MoWCD / NHA portals. Certified for frontline health workforce decision support.